Making the Right Connections

Initial Teacher Questionnaire

The purpose of this questionnaire is to identify reading materials that are appropriate for use with students who struggle with reading comprehension (described below).

Please answer the questions below considering the following description of a struggling comprehender:

The student reads grade-level reading material relatively fluently ***–at least 70 correct words in 1 minute–*** BUT **has difficulty comprehending grade-level reading material** (e.g., he or she struggles to recall what was read, has difficulty stating the main idea, or has difficulty answering inferential questions).

1. What type of data do you use to identify a student's **instructional reading level** (circle or highlight all that apply):
    a. Not applicable: I do not use data to identify students' reading levels.
    b. Fountas & Pinnell Benchmark Assessment System
    c. Developmental Reading Assessment (DRA)
    d. CBM-type measure (e.g., AIMSweb, DIBELS)
    e. Accelerated Reader – STAR tests
    f. Lexiles
    g. District assessment data (CALT/NALT/MAP)
    h. State assessment data (MCA)
    i. Teacher-made assessments
    j. Other (please specify): _____

2. For students who fit the ***struggling comprehender*** description above, what is the range of Fountas & Pinnell levels they are likely to be reading during FALL, WINTER, and SPRING. ***If you do not use the Fountas & Pinnell levels, please go to Question 3.***

FALL:	below L	L	M	N	O	P	Q	R	S	T	above T
WINTER:	below L	L	M	N	O	P	Q	R	S	T	above T
SPRING:	below L	L	M	N	O	P	Q	R	S	T	above T

3. If you do not use Fountas & Pinnell, do you use another leveling system? Yes No
(If the answer is "no," go to question 6.)

    If yes, what system do you primarily rely on? _____

4. Based on the system you use, what would you say is the approximate level of the struggling comprehenders in your class at Fall, Winter, and Spring (using the definition of struggling comprehenders provided at the beginning)?

   FALL:

   WINTER:

   SPRING:

5. For what purpose(s) do you use the above leveling information (circle or highlight all that apply):
   a. Benchmarking
   b. Instructional grouping
   c. Selecting texts
   d. Report card grades
   e. Communicating (informally) with parents
   f. Communicating with colleagues
   g. Communicating with administrators
   h. Other (please specify)

6. For ***struggling comprehenders***, please indicate (with a √) which types of reading materials you use for different instructional activities (if you don't use a certain type of material, leave the box blank).

Type of Reading Material	**Whole-class Lessons**	**Guided Reading**	**Partner Reading**	**Indepen-dent Reading**	**Other (please specify)**
Library books/children's literature (not leveled)					
Library books/children's literature (leveled, such as Accelerated Reader)					
Words Their Way books					
Reader's Theater books					
Other leveled reading materials designed specifically for instructional purposes					
Other (please specify)					

7. Please see the attached list of published books for elementary-aged students that have been leveled by Fountas & Pinnell (2010-2012), and either circle or highlight any books that you typically use with ***struggling comprehenders***. Please list any additional books, series, or reading materials that you are planning to use with struggling comprehenders in the coming year. Alternatively, you are welcome to attach any existing lists of reading materials that you use; if you do so, please be sure to clearly indicate which books you plan to use with ***struggling comprehenders***.

8. Please list any reading materials (including text books) that you use for science and social studies instruction. Please indicate if there are specific content area materials you recommend we use as part of the intervention.

9. What types of **text structures** do you emphasize in your reading instruction? Please circle or highlight all that apply.
    a. Narrative (story structure)
    b. Informational /expository
        i. Descriptive
        ii. Temporal/Sequence/Chronological Order
        iii. Compare and contrast
        iv. Problem and solution
        v. Cause and effect
    c. Other (please specify)

10. For the text structures you identified above, please put a STAR* next to any text structure that you believe poses particular difficulty for ***struggling comprehenders***, and that you think should be addressed as part of the Making the Right Connections intervention. Please feel free to add more information about your concerns below.

11. What is the approximate length (number of words) of reading material that you think is appropriate for a ***struggling comprehender*** to read during a 15-min time period (including previewing the text and answering questions)?

12. Please list any titles/series/publishers etc. that you do NOT want us to use for the Making the Right Connections intervention (e.g., any books that you definitely plan to use during your regular instruction, or books that you do not think are appropriate for the intervention). Please explain why you prefer these materials are not used.

13. Please list any titles/series/publishers etc. that you would especially LIKE us to use for the Making the Right Connections intervention (e.g., books that you do not plan to use during your regular instruction but would like students to be exposed to). Please explain why you prefer these materials are used.